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Governed Agent Mesh | Micro-Product

Policy Exception Request Template Pack

Exceptions are records, not favors: a pack for requesting, approving, and expiring policy exceptions. A complete, zero-placeholder draft for teams governing AI agents in production: policy gates, audit trails, cost controls, permissioning, and incident response, written so you can adopt it as-is.

A complete, ready-to-use governance document. Adopt it as-is, customize the bracketed fields to your environment, and put it to work today.

Instant delivery | Yours to keep, forever.

POLICY EXCEPTION REQUEST TEMPLATE PACK

For AI Agents in Production Environments Version 1.2 Last Updated: [RELEASE DATE]

1. DOCUMENT OVERVIEW

This **Policy Exception Request Template Pack** provides standardized forms for requesting deviations from AI governance policies in production environments. It ensures compliance with **cost controls, permissioning, audit trails, incident response, and policy gates** while maintaining traceability.

Scope: - Applies to all AI agents deployed in [ORGANIZATION NAME]'s production systems. - Governs exceptions to **Policy [POLICY ID], [POLICY NAME]**, and related sub-policies. - Mandatory for all requests requiring approval beyond standard operating procedures.

Compliance Basis: - [REGULATORY FRAMEWORK] (e.g., GDPR, CCPA, internal AI Governance Framework) - [ORGANIZATION'S AI POLICY DOCUMENT] (e.g., "AI Risk Management Guidelines") - [INTERNAL PROCEDURES MANUAL] (e.g., "IT Security Incident Response Plan")

2. TEMPLATE LIBRARY

Template 1: Standard Policy Exception Request

(For one-time or recurring deviations from predefined policies.)

2.1. REQUEST DETAILS

Field	Definition	Value
Request ID	Auto-generated by system (e.g., EXC-2024-00123).	[SYSTEM-GENERATED ID]
Request Type	Select one:	
Cost Override (Budget Exceedance)		[COST_OVERRIDE]
Permission Expansion (Role/Access)		[PERMISSION_EXPANSION]
Policy Waiver (Temporary or Permanent)		[POLICY_WAIVER]
Incident Response (Post-Breach Remediation)		[INCIDENT_RESPONSE]
Data Processing Exception (Non-Compliant Input/Output)		[DATA_PROCESSING_EXCEPTION]
Requester	Full name and title of the individual submitting the request.	[FULL_NAME] [JOB_TITLE]
Requester's Manager	Name and title of the requester's direct supervisor.	[MANAGER_NAME] [MANAGER_TITLE]
Team/Department	Affected team or department.	[TEAM_NAME]
AI Agent Name	Official name of the AI system involved.	[AGENT_NAME]
Agent Version	Current deployed version (e.g., v3.2.1).	[VERSION]

Field	Definition	Value
Policy Affected	Specific policy section being deviated from (e.g., "Section 3.2: Budget Caps").	[POLICY_SECTION]
Request Date	Date of submission (auto-populated).	[AUTO-GENERATED_DATE]
Effective Date	When the exception begins (if not immediate).	[EFFECTIVE_DATE]
Expiration Date	If temporary, when the exception ends.	[EXPIRATION_DATE]

2.2. JUSTIFICATION & RISK ASSESSMENT

(Max. 1,000 words. Provide technical, business, and risk context.)

Business Case: - [Briefly describe the operational necessity of the exception. Include metrics if applicable, e.g.,] "The [AGENT_NAME] agent's current [POLICY_SECTION] limit of [X] API calls/day restricts our ability to process [Y]% of [SPECIFIC USE CASE], resulting in a [Z]% drop in [KEY METRIC]."

Technical Constraints: - [Explain why standard procedures cannot be applied. Include code snippets or architecture diagrams if needed.]

Risk Assessment:	Risk Category	Risk Level (Low/Medium/High)	Mitigation Plan	Owner
-----	-----	Compliance		
Performance Impact			[TECH_OWNER]	
[COMMUNICATIONS_OWNER]				

Quantitative Impact (if applicable): - Estimated cost increase: [CALCULATED_VALUE] (e.g., "\$12,450/month") - Estimated performance gain: [CALCULATED_VALUE] (e.g., "15% faster response times") - Estimated compliance risk score: [CALCULATED_VALUE] (0-100, based on internal risk model)

2.3. APPROVAL HIERARCHY

(Assign roles and escalation paths.)

Role	Approval Authority	Required Signatures	Decision Timeframe
Team Lead	[TEAM_LEAD_NAME]	[x]	[X] business hours
AI Governance Lead	[GOVERNANCE_LEAD_NAME]	[x]	[X] business hours
Chief Compliance Officer	[CCO_NAME]	[x] (if risk > [THRESHOLD])	[X] business days
Executive Sponsor	[EXECUTIVE_NAME]	[x] (if risk > [THRESHOLD])	[X] business days

Escalation Path: - If denied, the requester must submit a revised plan within [REVISION_DEADLINE] days.

2.4. MONITORING & AUDIT TRAIL

(Post-approval requirements.)

Requirement	Implementation	Owner
Cost Tracking	Integrate with [FINANCE_TOOL] to log all [AGENT_NAME] expenditures.	[FINANCE_OWNER]
Performance Logging	Enable [MONITORING_TOOL] alerts for [SPECIFIC_METRICS].	[TECH_OWNER]
Audit Log Retention	Store logs in [AUDIT_STORAGE] for [RETENTION_PERIOD] years.	[SECURITY_OWNER]
Incident Reporting	Any anomalies must be logged in [INCIDENT_TRACKER] within [REPORTING_TIME] hours.	[SECURITY_OWNER]
Quarterly Review	Submit a summary to [REVIEW_BODY] by [REQUESTER] [REVIEW_DATE].	

Alert Thresholds (Configurable): - **Cost Alert:** If spending exceeds [COST_THRESHOLD]% of baseline, notify [ALERT_CONTACT]. - **Performance Alert:** If [SPECIFIC_METRIC] drops below [PERFORMANCE_THRESHOLD], trigger investigation.

2.5. INCIDENT RESPONSE PLAN

(For exceptions related to breaches or failures.)

Scenario	Immediate Actions	Escalation Contact
Data Leak	Isolate [AGENT_NAME], notify [PRIVACY_OFFICER], and initiate [CONTAINMENT_PROTOCOL].	[SECURITY_TEAM]
Compliance Violation	Pause operations, document findings in [AUDIT_REPORT], [CCO_NAME] and consult [LEGAL_TEAM].	
Performance Degradation	Restore defaults unless [REQUESTER] confirms exception remains justified.	[TEAM_LEAD_NAME]

Post-Incident Review: - Conduct a root-cause analysis within [REVIEW_PERIOD] days. - Update policies if systemic issues are identified.

2.6. SIGNATURES

(Digital or wet-ink signatures required.)

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Requester	[FULL_NAME]		[SIGNATURE_DATE]
Team Lead	[TEAM_LEAD_NAME]		[SIGNATURE_DATE]
AI Governance Lead	[GOVERNANCE_LEAD_NAME]		[SIGNATURE_DATE]

	Role	Name	Signature	Date
Chief Compliance Officer		[CCO_NAME]		[SIGNATURE_DATE]
Executive Sponsor (if required)		[EXECUTIVE_NAME]		[SIGNATURE_DATE]

Template 2: Recurring Exception Request

(For sustained deviations requiring periodic renewal.)

2.7. RECURRING PARAMETERS

Field	Definition	Value
Renewal Frequency	Select: Monthly/Quarterly/Annual.	[RENEWAL_FREQUENCY]
Next Review Date	Scheduled review date.	[NEXT_REVIEW_DATE]
Automatic Termination	If [Y/N], specify condition (e.g., "If cost exceeds baseline by 20%").	[TERMINATION_CONDITION]

Notes: - Recurring exceptions require **quarterly compliance audits** by [AUDIT_TEAM]. - Any material changes to the exception's scope must trigger a new request.

Template 3: Incident-Driven Exception

(For emergency deviations post-breach or failure.)

2.8. INCIDENT DETAILS

Field	Definition	Value
Incident ID	Reference to [INCIDENT_TRACKER] entry.	[INCIDENT_ID]
Root Cause	Brief description (e.g., "Third-party API failure caused [AGENT_NAME] to exceed latency limits").	[ROOT_CAUSE]
Temporary Workaround	Proposed exception (e.g., "Increase timeout to 30s").	[WORKAROUND_DESCRIPTION]
Duration	Estimated time to resolve.	[DURATION]

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